### Carmelite Open Day

A day of prayer, reflection and sharing with Carmelite friars and nuns for men and women aged 18–40. Saturday 21st November, 10.30 am–4.30 pm, Avila Retreat Centre, Donnybrook, Dublin. Register by 15th November: opendayavila@gmail.com.

### Abide Women's Conference

20th–22nd November, Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan and Nashville Dominicans. Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, Diocese of Cork & Ross. Visit "Abide in His Love" on Eventbrite.ie. Registration: abideinhislove.eventbrite.com.

*"It is therefore a holy and wholesome thought to pray for the dead, that they may be loosed from sins." — 2 Maccabees 12:46*

# BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES 8_NOVEMBER_2026

**No. 54 ~ THIRTY-SECOND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME**

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**PARISH CONTACT DETAILS**

**Fr. Peter Madden PP VF**
31 Sixtowns Road
Telephone: 79628376
Email:ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

**Fr Michael McCaul CC**
50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin
Telephone: 79632196
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

**PARISH OFFICES**

**Ballinascreen:**

9 High Street
Phone: (028)79628248
Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**
**Opening Hours:** Monday, Tuesday and Thursday: 8.45 am - 3.30 pm. Wednesday: 8.45 am - 3.00 pm.

**Desertmartin:**

St Patrick's Keenaught
Phone: (028)79397047
Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**
Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30 am to 3.00 pm.

**SAFEGUARDING**

**Safeguarding Contact Information**

If you have any concerns with regard to the safeguarding of children within the Church, please contact:
**Marie O'Kane -** Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) Tel.: +44 7596 500793 or Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org
**Northern Ireland Emergency Services**

- PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101
- Social Services:
  - Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (ask for the Duty Social Worker)
  - Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459
  - Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995

**LIFELINE**

Tel: 0808 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808 808 8000.
www.lifelinehelpline.info

**SVP HELPLINE**

Helpline telephone number: 07710838050

**GAMBLING HELPLINE**

Help is available, phone: 02871351329

**SPERRIN FOODBANK**

Tel: 07543420639

**BALLINASCREEN COMMUNITY SUPPORT GROUP**

Please click the link https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-community-support-gro for full details of Ballinascreen Community Support Group.

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**NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN**

Notices for the Bulletin should be received by 1.00 pm on Wednesday, preferably by email.

Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**

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**VIGIL MASSES FOR SUNDAY**

Holy Rosary: 6.00 pm

St Patrick's, Keenaught: **4.30 pm - NB New Time**

**SUNDAY MASSES**

St Columba's, Straw: 9.00 am

St Mary's, Coolcalm: 10.00 am

St Patrick's, Sixtowns: 11.00 am

St Eugene's, Moneyneena: 12 noon

**MASSES FOR THIS WEEK**

**Monday ~ 9 November**

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary - Mass in honour of Padre Pio.

**Tuesday ~ 10 November**

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

**Wednesday ~ 11 November**

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

**Thursday ~ 12 November**

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

**Friday ~ 13 November**

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary Church.

**CONFESSIONS**

**Ballinascreen:** Holy Rosary at 5.30 pm - before Vigil Mass on Saturday.

**Desertmartin:** St. Patrick's, Keenaught at 4.00 pm - before Vigil Mass on Saturday.

**FEASTS OF THE WEEK**

**Monday 9 November:** The Dedication of The Lateran Basilica.

**Tuesday 10 November:** St Leo the Great.

**Wednesday 11 November:** St Martin of Tours

**Thursday 12 November:** St Josaphat

**Friday 13 November:** St Laurence O'Toole

**DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY**

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20. Prayers for the happy repose of the souls of the recently deceased members and all deceased members of the Derry Diocesan Society will take place at the Masses on the weekends of 7/8 November and 14/15 November.

**MASS IN HONOUR OF PADRE PIO**

The monthly mass in honour of St. Pio of Pietrelcina will be celebrated on Monday 9 November at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church. Novena prayers and rosary at 7.00 pm. Adoration from 12 noon until 7.30 pm.

**ANNUAL MASS FOR DECEASED PARISHIONERS**

- Tuesday 17 November at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.
- Wednesday 18 November at 7.30 pm in St Patrick's Keenaught.

The names of all who died or were buried in our parish since last year's Parish Mass of Remembrance will be read out at this Mass. After all the names have been read out, a member of each of these bereaved families, will be invited to carry a lit candle to the altar. Each family should ensure that an adult has been selected to represent them. Candles will be provided at the back of the church during this Mass.

**CHANGE OF MASS TIME**

The Anniversary Mass on **Friday 20 November in Holy Rosary Church, will be held at the earlier time of 7.00 pm**, this schedule adjustment has been made to accommodate the town's Christmas lights switch-on event occurring the same evening.

**MONTH'S MIND MASS**

The Month's Mind Mass for Jacinta McEldowney, will take place on Saturday 14 November in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught at 4.30 pm.
The Month's Mind Mass for Terrence Hegarty, Ranaghan Road, will take place on Friday 20 November at 7.00 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

**FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS**

The First Anniversary Mass for Brigid O'Neill, née Burke, Magherafelt will be held on Friday 20 November at 7.00 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

**ANNIVERSARIES**

**Ballinascreen:**

Annie Kelly, Mallon Villas;
Victor Lynn, Cordarragh;
Josephine Trainor, Moneyneena Rd.;
Marie Mullen, Glenshane Park;
Margaret McBride, Campbelltown Terrace.

**Desertmartin:**

Rose O'Hagan;
Selina O'Hagan;
Jimmy Lyttle;
Jim McIvor;
Gerry Murray;
Nellie Trainor;
Anne McGuigan;
Rosie Donnelly.

**BAPTISMS**

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:
Jude Thomas Glasgow, Cahore Terrace;
Nora Sarah Conlon & Conall Patrick Conlon, Brackaghislea Road.

**PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES WITH BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER**

Led by Bishop Michael Router. There are two options available as follows:

**Option 1**: 8 - 13 July, 5 nights, £980, from City of Derry Airport, with priority given to Assisted Pilgrims and family members, Care Team, Youth, Youth Leaders and Priests.

**Option 2**: 7 - 14 July, 7 nights, £1,095, from Belfast International Airport. Single Supplement and Travel Insurance will be extra. Expressions of Interest can be emailed to derrypilgrim@outlook.com. Bookings will begin in mid-January, with more details later. Pilgrimage Gift Vouchers of any value are available from the Pastoral Centre, Bishop Street, Derry, for anyone wishing to purchase them, particularly as a Christmas Gift. Please contact 028 7136 2475 for further information.

**FATIMA PILGRIMAGE**

Fully escorted group to Fatima accompanied by Spiritual Director, 28 June – 5 July 2027. Direct Daytime Flights Belfast to Porto return. Staying in 4* Hotel. Full Board. Services of JWT Pilgrimage Guide. Daily Mass & Spiritual Activities. Cost £975pps. Early Booking Offer: £100 OFF if Paid In Full by 30 November 2026. Further details contact Christina Lagan 07803192621

**SHRINES OF FRANCE PILGRIMAGE**

Lisieux, Rue Du Bac, Nevers, Paris, Rocamadour and Lourdes - fully escorted pilgrimage from 11 to 18 June 2027. 7 Nights flying from Dublin to Paris/Lourdes to Dublin. Including visits to the home of the Miraculous Medal, and to see the incorrupt bodies of St Catherine Laboure and St Bernadette. In Paris visit Sacre-Coeur, Lourdes, plus much more. Comprehensive Travel insurance is **extra** £35.00. Cost: £1,200 **per person sharing. Places are limited**. Single room supplement is £345.00 **extra**. Spiritual Director: Fr Joe McGuigan. £250.00 deposit secures a seat! For further details contact: Jean Reynolds 07729 402311 or Email: jeanreynolds@hotmail.co.uk

**PARISH COLLECTIONS**

**Ballinascreen:**

Weekly Collection - £3547.80

Renovation Collection - £2468.50

Mission Collection - £81.50 (Total: £1592.65)

**Desertmartin:**

Weekly Collection - £1183.20

Renovation Collection - £686.20

Mission Collection - £145

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

Totals shown include October Standing Orders from Parishioners. If would like to avail of this option please contact the Parish Office.

**CHOIR DIRECTOR: ST EUGENE'S CATHEDRAL, DERRY**

10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack - Tel.: (028) 7126 2302 or Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or Email to: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications to be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026.

**DERRY DIOCESE VOCATIONS**

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4.00 pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan - Email: pgoh2111@gmail.com or Tel.: (028) 79386259.

**TROCAIRE IS LOOKING FOR VOLUNTEERS**

To help deliver school talks during our annual Lent Appeal during **February and March 2027.** We are particularly interested in hearing from people with public speaking experience, especially retired teachers or those who have worked with young people. Volunteers will visit local schools during school hours to share stories of hope, justice and solidarity from communities around the world. The role involves approximately **1-2 short talks per week** during the four-month campaign period. Full training, presentation materials and ongoing support will be provided. Please contact Fionnuala McGuinness on 028 9080 8033 or fionnuala.mcguinness@trocaire.org by the first week of December if you are interested!

**WARM WELCOME WEDNESDAY**

In Workspace Community Hub, Wednesday 11 November from 11.00 am to 1.00 pm. We will be joined by Inspire Wellbeing at 11.45 am for a mental health and wellbeing session. Inspire Wellbeing is an all-island charity focused on mental health, intellectual disabilities and addiction support. This session provides participants with an opportunity to consider what we really mean by 'mental health' and how we can look after our mental health and strengthen our overall wellbeing. Booking not required, just drop in on the day. Free tea, coffee and refreshments also served.

**HAEMOCHROMATOSIS COFFEE EVENING**

Free event, for anyone who suffers with haemochromatosis, waiting on diagnoses or family & friends, to learn more & support one another. Neil from haemochromatosis UK will be in attendance, to answer questions & offer advice & guidance. Venue: The Community Hub (next to library), Draperstown on Wednesday 11 November from 6.30 pm to 8.00 pm. All welcome.

**ABIDE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE 2026**

**20 - 22 November.** Join hundreds of women at the **Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran,** Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Kimberlee Woo Ling, Fr Oisín Martin CFR, Fr Barry Braum, the Nashville Dominican Sisters, Fr David Nugent and Fr Mark Wharton, with Holy Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. A weekend of **faith, celebration, healing and joy! Register on Eventbrite: Abide in His Love.**

**FREE STRESS CONTROL CLASSES**

The classes are **FREE** and the next round will commence on **Monday 9 November at 9.00 am**, with session two on the following Monday at 9.00 am (**16 November**). Access the online classes at https://ni.stresscontrol.org/.

**RANGANNA GAEILGE / IRISH LANGUAGE CLASSES**

Join a growing community to learn Irish in a fun, welcoming environment! A New Christmas Themed 6-week course is starting on Monday 9 November in St Mary's Hall, Desertmartin, wrapping up with a festive *Céili Na Nollaig* (Christmas Céili) in the pub during Christmas week.

**Bunrang (Beginners):** 6:45pm – 8.00 pm.

**Meanrang (Improvers):** 8.00 pm – 9:30 pm

Spaces are limited. To book a place - Email: **knocknaginhc@gmail.com**, or Tel.: Edward **07835161927** / Gerard **02879631744**.